

## TEAM 4 · Take Tenuta Corte Aurelia into GERMANY

Wine Business Program 2026 · **Generative AI Workshop** Tool for today: **Microsoft 365 Copilot Chat** at <https://m365.cloud.microsoft/chat>

**This handout is self-contained.** The company, the CEO's brief, your market and *your* cost line are all in here. Everything else you need is in the `case_study_helper_info` folder next to this file: the Prompting Guide (read it before you start), the rescue guide, and the indicative deck.

### 1. The company

**Tenuta Corte Aurelia** is a family-owned **Chianti Classico DOCG** estate in **Greve in Chianti, Tuscany**, in the heart of the Gallo Nero zone.

|                       |                                                                             |
|-----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Founded</b>        | 1952 · third generation · family-owned                                      |
| <b>Run by</b>         | Elena Aurelia (CEO, commercial) and Marco Aurelia (winemaker)               |
| <b>Estate</b>         | 45 ha total · 28 ha under vine (250–420 m, galestro and alberese soils)     |
| <b>Certifications</b> | Certified sustainable (Equalitas) · final year of <b>organic conversion</b> |
| <b>Grapes</b>         | Sangiovese 90% · Canaiolo · Colorino                                        |
| <b>Production</b>     | ~180,000 bottles per year                                                   |

#### The portfolio

| Wine                                       | Type                                 | Volume      | Ex-cellar price |
|--------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|-------------|-----------------|
| <b>Corte Aurelia</b>                       | Chianti Classico Annata DOCG         | ~90,000 btl | €7.50           |
| <b>Vigna del Sasso</b>                     | Chianti Classico Riserva DOCG        | ~40,000 btl | €12.00          |
| <b>Aurelia</b>                             | Chianti Classico Gran Selezione DOCG | ~15,000 btl | €20.00          |
| Rosato Toscana IGP · Sangiovese/Merlot IGT | Entry / experimental                 | ~35,000 btl | Italy only      |

**Story assets:** 70+ years of family heritage · restored 16th-century farmhouse · 8-room agriturismo · ~4,000 wine-tourism visitors per year · hand-harvest · native yeasts on the top wines · organic conversion.

**Current sales mix (by volume):** Italy 55% (HoReCa and enoteche) · Europe 30% (Switzerland, Austria, Benelux) · Rest of world 15% (one-off containers to the US and Asia through traders, with no ongoing importer).

**The situation:** domestic growth has plateaued. The family has decided to invest in **one priority export market** and build it properly, rather than scattering samples everywhere. Corte Aurelia has no market-specific packaging, no localized marketing, no in-market PR and no critic ratings in that market.

### 2. A letter from the CEO

*To the export task force,*

*We have money set aside for one market. Not three, one. I have given you €120,000 for the first year: travel, samples, a trade fair, adapted materials, importer support, launch activity.*

*Pick the right wine, the right channel and the right story for the market you have been given, and convince me. I want to know three things. **What we would earn. What it really costs me to get there. And how I would know, within twelve months, whether it is actually working**, because by then it will be too late to guess.*

*Do not bring me a spreadsheet. Bring me a decision I can sign off, and be honest about what you assumed.*

*One more thing. We are not discounting our way into anybody's market. Whatever you propose, the premium holds.*

*Elena*

**Your market is Germany.** One market per team. You own it.

**About the market pack.** The market briefing in section 3 was put together by our intern over the last few months as an internal research exercise. Treat it as a **starting point**, not as the final word: it is there to save you from a blank page. Elena is explicitly open to further information the task force can find on its own, as long as you say where it came from and flag anything in the pack you end up disagreeing with.

How you get there is up to you. What you hand in is in section 5.

### 3. Your market: GERMANY

**Why Germany.** Europe's largest wine importer by volume, and on your doorstep: EU logistics mean no tariffs and no customs friction. The organic "Bio" segment is huge and trusted, and a serious quality segment sits right next to Europe's toughest discount retail, which is exactly why the premium is hard to hold.

#### How the market works

- **Discounters (Aldi, Lidl) dominate the value end. Avoid them.**
- Your targets are **Fachhandel** (specialist wine trade), **Bio and organic retail**, and **city on-trade**.
- E-commerce is mature and sizeable.

#### The consumer

- Price-conscious overall, but with a large and serious quality segment.
- **Sustainability and organic certification are decisive trust signals.** Your conversion is the lever.
- German buyers value clear typicity and reliability. Expect strong competition from established Italian importers.

#### Constraints

- EU rules, so labelling is straightforward. A German back-label and clear organic labelling help.
- Organic and sustainability claims must be accurate. Your conversion is in its final year, so say exactly what you can claim today.

#### 3.1 Three questions Germany forces you to answer

Not hints, just the questions your pitch has to survive. Answer them with numbers from section 4.

1. Germany has the lowest price-ladder inputs of any market on the list: no duty, no excise, the cheapest freight. **Where does that advantage actually land?** In your margin, in the importer's, or on the shelf price? And is a cheaper shelf price good news for a premium wine?

2. Fachhandel, Bio retail and city on-trade are three different buyers with three different price logics. **Are you building one plan or three**, and can the stock available in section 4.2 support them?
3. Discounters own the value end and established Italian importers own the middle. **Which of your wines can stand next to them at its shelf price**, and in which channel?

## 4. The Data Pack

These are Corte Aurelia's internal planning figures, agreed with the CFO. **Use these numbers.** Do not ask Copilot to look up different ones, and do not let it invent its own. If you need a figure that is not here, assume it, write the assumption down, and say so in your pitch.

### 4.1 What a bottle costs us to make

| Wine           | Ex-cellar price | Variable cost per bottle | Contribution per bottle |
|----------------|-----------------|--------------------------|-------------------------|
| Annata         | €7.50           | €4.20                    | €3.30                   |
| Riserva        | €12.00          | €6.30                    | €5.70                   |
| Gran Selezione | €20.00          | €9.50                    | €10.50                  |

Variable cost covers grapes, vinification, ageing, bottle, cork, label and case. It excludes estate overheads, which are already carried by the domestic business.

### 4.2 Extra cost of selling into an export market

| Item                                            | Figure                  |
|-------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|
| Export compliance and market-specific labelling | <b>€0.15 per bottle</b> |
| Year-1 market-entry budget (fixed, one-off)     | <b>€120,000</b>         |
| Case size                                       | 12 bottles              |

**Stock available for the new market in Year 1.** The volumes below are uncommitted and available for this initiative. They are included in the estate's planned annual production figures in section 1, not additional production.

Existing customer commitments are protected. For this exercise, assume this allocation has no alternative sales opportunity in Year 1: export sales do not replace domestic sales.

| Wine           | Available in Year 1 |
|----------------|---------------------|
| Annata         | 30,000 btl          |
| Riserva        | 12,000 btl          |
| Gran Selezione | 4,000 btl           |

*These are hard supply ceilings, not sales forecasts. We earn contribution only on bottles the importer actually buys, and an importer buys only what it believes it can sell at full price. Management's expectation of Year-1 demand is set out in section 4.6. Whether your market can really absorb that volume, and in which wines, is your assumption to make and defend. Bottles not purchased by the importer remain in the estate's inventory and generate no Year-1 sales contribution.*

**The financial measure:** Year-1 market result =  $\Sigma(\text{bottles sold} \times \text{contribution per bottle}) - €120,000$ . Contribution per bottle is ex-cellar price minus variable cost minus the €0.15 export cost. "Net result" in the

supporting materials means this same measure.

This is the market's contribution after launch spending, not total estate profit or cash flow. Existing estate overheads, inventory financing and the future value of unsold stock are outside the exercise. Production costs remain in the contribution calculation: uncommitted stock does not mean free wine.

### 4.3 Your market's price-ladder inputs: GERMANY

Figures are per bottle unless stated. **None of these is the estate's cost.** Under our terms the importer pays freight, duty and excise and passes them down the chain, so they do not reduce your contribution per bottle. They decide the shelf price.

| Item                  | Germany               |
|-----------------------|-----------------------|
| Freight & insurance   | €0.15                 |
| Import duty           | 0% (EU single market) |
| Excise / alcohol tax  | €0.00                 |
| Consumer VAT on shelf | 19%                   |

*Import duty percentages apply to the landed value, meaning ex-cellar price plus freight. The 19% VAT is charged last, on the retail price, after every trade mark-up.*

### 4.4 The trade chain (same in every market)

| Step                 | Mark-up on their own cost |
|----------------------|---------------------------|
| Importer             | +30%                      |
| Distributor          | +25%                      |
| Retail, off-trade    | +40%                      |
| Restaurant, on-trade | 3x the price they pay     |

### 4.5 Exchange rate

**None.** Germany is in the euro zone — no conversion, and no currency risk to model.

### 4.6 The board's stated ambition

One quality importer appointed · **25,000 bottles sold in Year 1** · 60,000 by Year 3 · premium positioning protected.

*The 25,000 bottles is management's view of what the market could absorb in Year 1, not a stock figure. These are Elena's targets, not facts. If your analysis says they are wrong for Germany, say so and show her why.*

## 5. What you hand in

**1. A PowerPoint deck that contains your analysis.** Built with **Copilot Chat using Think Deeper (GPT-5.6)**.

Maximum **10 slides**. Download it as a `.pptx`. The PowerPoint should be built on top of your final analysis.

**2. One generated image. A positioning visual for Germany:** the single image you would put in front of a local importer, buyer or consumer to win the business. Label concept, campaign visual, gift pack, tasting-event key visual, your choice. It has to work in *Germany*, not in Tuscany. Put it in the deck.

**3. A 5-minute pitch** to Elena and the board (the class and the professor), then a **2-minute reflection** on working with the AI: what prompt worked, what it got wrong, what you would never trust it with.

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## 6. Two rules

1. **Show your assumptions.** Every number you invented gets stated out loud.
  2. **Be creative, and have fun with it.** This is a real decision with a real budget, but nobody is going to lose their job over it. Take a position, make it interesting, and enjoy the argument.
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## 7. Suggested time box

|         |                                                           |
|---------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| ~45 min | Understand the market, build the analysis, stress-test it |
| ~45 min | Generate the image, build the deck                        |
| ~30 min | Rehearse and sharpen the pitch                            |

**Checkpoint at 15 minutes:** every team tells the room, in one sentence, **which wine they are leading with and through which channel**. If you cannot say it in one sentence, you are not ready to build yet.

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## 8. Working with Copilot

Two supporting guides sit in the `case_study_helper_info` folder next to this file. Read the first before you start.

- `case_study_helper_info/01_Prompting-Guide.md` — how to set up the session, how to write a prompt that works, and starter prompts for each hand-in. It is there to give you a **head start**, not a script: the starter prompts are yours to lift, adapt or ignore. **You have full freedom in what you submit and how you get there** — the guide just saves you the blank page.
- `case_study_helper_info/02_If-You-Get-Stuck.md` — open it if you stall, or if the numbers will not reconcile. A five-question method for getting to a decision, plus the three core calculations — contribution, the price ladder, the Year-1 total — written out step by step.

**Setting up the session:** upload *this handout* to Copilot Chat. It contains the brief and the Germany market pack in one file, so one upload is enough. Wherever the Prompting Guide says "[YOUR MARKET]", write **Germany**. Wherever it says "your Market Card", it means **section 3 of this handout**.

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## 9. Final deliverables

Section 5 says *what* to hand in. This section says what "finished" looks like, so you can check yourselves before you stand up.

### 9.1 The submission checklist

| # | Deliverable                          | Format                                                                               | Done when...                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|---|--------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | <b>Board deck, analysis included</b> | <code>.pptx</code> , <b>maximum 10 slides</b> , built with Copilot Chat Think Deeper | It answers Elena's three questions (what we earn, what it costs, how she knows it is working), carries <b>both financial and non-financial indicators</b> , states every assumption you invented, opens cleanly, and sells the decision even without you talking over it |

| # | Deliverable               | Format                                                  | Done when...                                                                                                                                |
|---|---------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2 | <b>Positioning visual</b> | One generated image ( .png / .jpg ), placed in the deck | It would work in front of an importer, buyer or consumer <b>in Germany</b> , not in Tuscany                                                 |
| 3 | <b>Pitch + reflection</b> | 5 minutes + 2 minutes, live                             | Rehearsed and timed, and the reflection names a prompt that worked, something the AI got wrong, and something you would never trust it with |

**Non-negotiable in all three:** the premium holds, every invented number is flagged as an assumption, and all economics trace back to the Data Pack in section 4.

## 9.2 What Elena expects to see

Five things have to be in your deck. If a slide does not eventually lead to one of them, cut the slide.

1. **Which wine or wines, through which channel** — one sentence, no hedging.
2. **Contribution per bottle** for each wine you lead with: ex-cellar price minus variable cost minus the €0.15 export cost. It is the same in every market, because the importer pays freight and taxes.
3. **Year-1 volume, total contribution, and the Year-1 market result after the €120,000 launch spending**, as defined in section 4.2.
4. **Break-even volume**, and how much margin for error that leaves you.
5. **A strategy pack with your recommendations for Germany.** The moves you would make, in priority order: route to market and the partner you want, pricing and positioning, the story you lead with, the launch activity, and how the €120,000 is split between them. For each one, say why it fits Germany and what Elena has to decide. Close with a clear call: **go, go with conditions, or not yet**, and the conditions.

## 9.3 Indicative 8-slide deck structure

A shape that works. Not a rule. Adapt it to the German story.

| Slide | Working title                                   | What it has to do                                                                                             |
|-------|-------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1     | <b>The recommendation</b>                       | Market, wine, channel, and three headline numbers (volume, ROI, break-even). The whole answer, up front       |
| 2     | <b>The obvious plan, and why we rejected it</b> | Show the tempting option and let the numbers kill it. This is where you earn credibility                      |
| 3     | <b>What the market pays for a bottle</b>        | The price ladder: ex-cellar → freight → importer → distributor → retail → VAT. Finish on the shelf price in € |
| 4     | <b>The Year-1 plan</b>                          | Wine × volume × channel × contribution, with totals and the net against €120,000                              |
| 5     | <b>Scenarios</b>                                | Downside, base, upside. Say what breaks in the downside and what actually limits the upside                   |
| 6     | <b>How Elena will know it is working</b>        | Your indicators, with targets, review rhythm, and the action if each one misses                               |
| 7     | <b>The positioning visual</b>                   | Your generated image, plus one line on why it works in Germany                                                |
| 8     | <b>The ask</b>                                  | What you need signed off, the 12-month gates, and the one point of failure you are flagging honestly          |

## 9.4 An indicative deck is provided

`case_study_helper_info/99_Indicative-Submission_Deck.pptx` is a **market-neutral skeleton** of the eight slides above: the structure and the level of specificity expected, with placeholders where your answer goes. It contains no answers for any market.

The skeleton has no dedicated slide for the strategy pack in 9.2: put it on slide 8, or add one or two slides of your own. You have up to 10.

Use it to calibrate. Do not copy its wording, and do not worry about matching its layout: your deck comes out of Copilot Chat and will look different. You are judged on whether the deck sells the decision, not on how polished it is.

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